

turn on your device, the first thing to get kick-started is the bootloader. This is what will decide what to run first - the recovery, the Android (also known as the system) or the radio. The radio is important because it is what is a controller for your phone's internal antennas. This is how your device connects with the carrier's towers.

Recovery, however, is a separate runtime environment. It functions like a mini operating system separate from the Android system and is capable of performing several system-related tasks. The stock recovery options on most Android devices will allow you to clear user as well as cache content, as is the case when you want to run a factory reset. It can also access over-the-air updates as well as make provisions for tools present on an SD card to run functions on the phone.

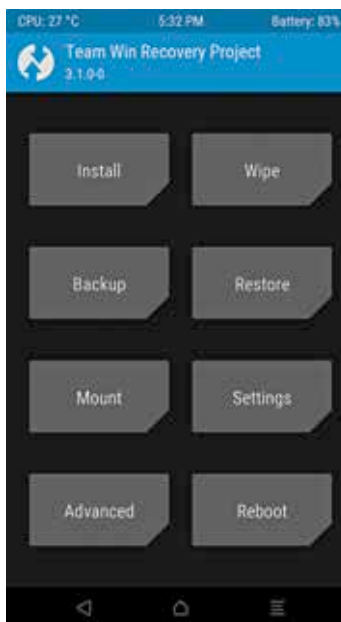
So in reality, recovery is a piece of software that is independent of the operating system in your device. It has the capability of controlling systems settings and functions, but is incapable of performing the same actions or functions. Once Android starts loading, recovery is rendered idle.

Custom recovery

There are stock recoveries and then there are custom recoveries. Custom recoveries can be run atop stock recoveries. Here's a few things you will be able to do if you run a custom recovery -

- Flash a third party ROM onto your device
- Perform Nandroid backups - these backups help you save everything from personal data to even the OS
- Modify the recovery interface to be more user-friendly or appealing.
- Connecting with the Android Debug Bridge (ADB) on a computer (We'll be getting back to this one later)

There are two most popular choices out there when it comes to custom recoveries - Team Win



TWRP is a popular choice for a custom recovery